

The Ultimate New Condo Defect Check Guide

A complimentary guide by IdealHub

Congratulations on receiving the keys to your new condo! Taking Vacant Possession (VP) is an exciting milestone. However, before you move in or hand over the unit to your renovation contractor, it is crucial to conduct a thorough defect check (commonly known as "snagging"). Identifying and reporting defects now ensures the developer rectifies them for free under your Defect Liability Period (DLP), preventing costly repairs and avoiding delays to your IdealHub renovation timeline.

The IdealHub Defect Check Toolkit

Don't just rely on your eyes. Bring this simple toolkit to your inspection:

- ☐ **Masking tape or sticky notes & a marker** (to mark and label defects on-site)
- ☐ **Smartphone with a good camera** (for clear photo and video evidence)
- ☐ **Torchlight or phone flashlight** (to check dark corners, under sinks, and inside cabinets)
- ☐ **A small marble or ball** (to test floor leveling and bathroom/balcony drainage slope)
- ☐ **A coin or small tapping hammer** (to tap tiles and check for hollow sounds)
- ☐ **A bucket or large water bottle** (to test drainage and water ponding)
- ☐ **A simple plug tester or phone charger** (to test electrical sockets)

1. Entrance & Doors

- ☐ **Door Alignment:** Open and close the main door and all room doors. They should close smoothly without sticking, dragging, or rubbing against the frame.
- ☐ **Scratches & Dents:** Inspect both sides of the doors and frames for any cosmetic damage from installation.
- ☐ **Hardware:** Check that all locks, deadbolts, handles, and hinges function properly and are securely screwed in.
- ☐ **Door Stopper:** Ensure the door stopper is installed, functional, and doesn't clash with the handle.

2. Walls & Ceilings

- ☐ **Cracks:** Look for hairline or structural cracks, especially near corners, window frames, and ceiling joints.
- ☐ **Paint Finish:** Check for uneven paint, drips, bubbles, or color mismatches.
- ☐ **Water Stains:** Look for yellowish/brownish discoloration on ceilings or walls (a sign of potential leaks from the unit above or external seepage).
- ☐ **Hollow Plaster:** Lightly tap walls with a coin. A hollow sound indicates poor plaster adhesion, which can lead to cracking or flaking later.

3. Flooring

- ☐ **Hollow Tiles:** Tap across all floor tiles (especially in the center and corners). Hollow-sounding tiles may crack under furniture weight and must be replaced by the developer.
- ☐ **Scratches & Chips:** Inspect for visible damage to tiles, vinyl, or parquet flooring.
- ☐ **Levelness:** Roll a marble across the floor. It shouldn't roll rapidly to one side (unless it's a wet area designed to slope toward a drain).
- ☐ **Grout & Skirting:** Ensure grout lines are even, clean, and skirting boards are firmly attached with no gaps.

4. Windows (Critical for Malaysian Weather!)

- ☐ **Glass:** Check for scratches, chips, or cracks on the glass panes.
- ☐ **Seals & Frames:** Inspect the rubber sealing for gaps or tears. Check the frame for scratches or poor alignment. Poor sealing leads to water leaks during heavy tropical rain.
- ☐ **Operation:** Open, close, and lock every window. They should operate smoothly without excessive force.
- ☐ **Weep Holes:** Ensure the drainage holes at the bottom of the window frame are not blocked by cement or debris.

5. Kitchen

- ☐ **Cabinets & Drawers:** Open and close all cabinets and drawers. Check for smooth gliding, proper alignment, and soft-close functionality (if specified in your SPA).
- ☐ **Countertops:** Inspect for cracks, chips, or poorly sealed seams (especially around the sink, which can cause water to seep into the cabinet below).
- ☐ **Sink & Taps:** Turn on the tap to check water pressure. Fill the sink and release the plug to ensure fast drainage with no leaks under the cabinet.

6. Bathrooms & Balconies (Highest Risk Areas!)

- ☐ **Water Ponding:** Pour a bucket of water on the floor. It should flow smoothly toward the floor trap without pooling in corners.
- ☐ **Hollow Tiles:** Tap wall and floor tiles. Hollow wall tiles can detach over time, and hollow floor tiles can crack.
- ☐ **Sanitary Ware:** Check the toilet bowl, sink, and mirrors for scratches, chips, or cracks. Flush the toilet multiple times to ensure proper function and no running water.
- ☐ **Leaks:** Run the shower and taps. Check under the sink and around the pipe connections for any drips or moisture.
- ☐ **Exhaust Fan:** Turn it on to ensure it works, is vented correctly to the outside, and doesn't make excessive noise.
- ☐ **AC Ledge Drainage:** If accessible/visible, ensure the air-conditioning ledge has a proper floor trap and slopes correctly to prevent overflowing water into your unit or the facade.

7. Electrical & Plumbing

- ☐ **Sockets & Switches:** Plug in your tester/charger to check every single power socket. Flip all light switches on and off.
- ☐ **DB Box (Distribution Board):** Ensure all circuit breakers (ELCB/MCB) are labeled correctly and do not trip when multiple appliances are turned on.
- ☐ **Water Pressure:** Test all taps and showerheads. If pressure is unusually low, it could be a blocked pipe or developer supply issue.

How to Report Defects Properly in Malaysia

- ☐ **1. Mark It** — Place a piece of masking tape next to every defect and write a brief description (e.g., 'Hollow tile', 'Scratch on glass').
- ☐ **2. Photo Document** — Take clear, well-lit photos of each defect. Include a wide shot (to show location) and a close-up (to show the defect).
- ☐ **3. Fill the Form** — Complete the developer's official defect liability form. Be specific, list every item, and attach your photos. Submit this to the Developer's Customer Care Centre or the Joint Management Body (JMB) / Management Corporation (MC).
- ☐ **4. Keep a Copy** — Always retain a dated, stamped copy of the submitted form. Follow up within the stated timeframe (usually 14–30 days).

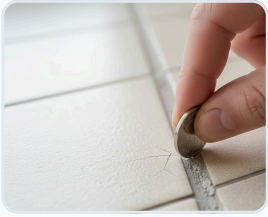
GOLDEN RULE

Do not start your renovation until major structural, waterproofing, or tiling defects are fixed by the developer. If you cover up a defect with your own renovation work, the developer will likely reject the DLP claim, and you will bear the cost.

Notes

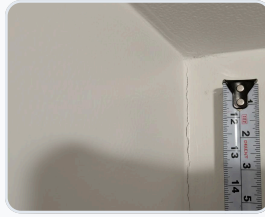
10 Must-Have Defect Check — Visual Reference

Use these real-world examples to help you identify similar defects in your new unit.



1. Hollow Floor Tiles

Tap tiles with a coin. A hollow sound means poor adhesion — report immediately.



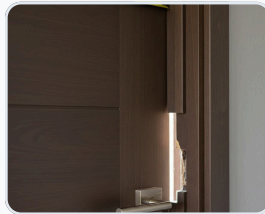
2. Hairline Wall Cracks

Check wall corners and ceiling joints for fine cracks that may indicate settling.



3. Water Stain on Ceiling

Yellow-brown marks on ceilings suggest water seepage from above.



4. Misaligned Door Frame

Doors should close flush without gaps, dragging, or sticking.



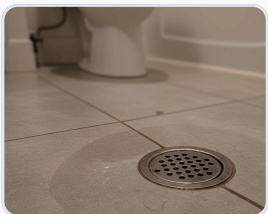
5. Cracked Tile

Photograph cracked tiles close-up and from a distance to show the location and extent of damage.



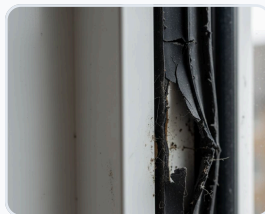
6. Water Ponding on Bathroom Floor

Pour water on the floor — it should flow to the drain, not pool in corners.



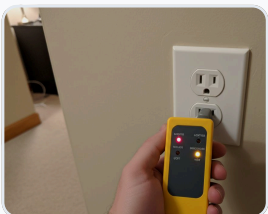
7. Poor Drainage

Pour water near floor drains — it should flow freely. Capture pooling or slow drainage as evidence.



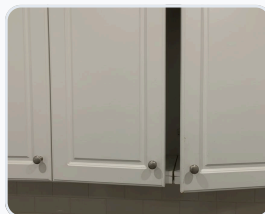
8. Damaged Window Seal

Check rubber seals around all windows — gaps lead to rain leaks.



9. Electrical Socket Not Working

Use a socket tester on every outlet — photograph the tester showing a fault indicator.



10. Cabinet Misalignment

Check cabinet doors and drawers for uneven gaps — photograph gaps that are visibly inconsistent.